HOORVIA — MEAT RESTING TIME & CARRYOVER TEMPERATURE GUIDE

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet • Exact Rest Minutes by Cut • Carryover °F Rise & Foil Tenting Rules • US Letter (8.5" × 11")

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■ MANDATORY RESTING TIME & CARRYOVER TEMPERATURE RISE BY CUT

Meat / Poultry Cut	Cut Weight / Thickness	Expected Carryover Rise	Ideal Rest Time	Foil Tenting Instruction
Thin Steak / Pork Chop (1/2–3/4")	6 to 8 oz	+2°F to +4°F (+1°C–2°C)	3 – 5 minutes	Leave uncovered on warm plate
Thick Steak / Ribeye / Strip (1.25–1.5")	12 to 16 oz	+5°F to +7°F (+3°C–4°C)	6 – 8 minutes	Leave uncovered (Keeps sear crisp!)
Boneless Chicken Breast / Thigh	6 to 8 oz	+4°F to +5°F (+2°C–3°C)	5 minutes	Tent loosely w/ foil to trap moisture
Pork Tenderloin / Rack of Lamb	1 to 2 lbs	+5°F to +6°F (+3°C)	7 – 10 minutes	Tent loosely with foil
Whole Roast Chicken / Duck	3.5 to 5 lbs	+6°F to +8°F (+3°C–4°C)	15 – 20 minutes	Leave uncovered so skin stays glassy
Beef Tenderloin / Pork Loin Roast	3 to 4 lbs	+7°F to +10°F (+4°C–6°C)	15 – 20 minutes	Tent loosely with foil
Prime Rib / Leg of Lamb Roast	5 to 8 lbs	+10°F to +14°F (+6°C–8°C)	20 – 30 minutes	Tent loosely; slice right before serving
Whole Thanksgiving Turkey	12 to 20 lbs	+8°F to +12°F (+5°C–7°C)	30 – 40 minutes	Uncovered! Foil steam ruins crispy skin
Smoked Brisket / Pulled Pork Butt	8 to 14 lbs	+2°F (Low-temp cook)	1 to 3 hours!	Wrap in butcher paper & rest in dry cooler

■ MOISTURE RETENTION COMPARISON: SLICED IMMEDIATELY VS. PROPERLY RESTED

Resting Duration (1-Inch Steak / Breast)	Internal Muscle Fiber State	Juice Loss on Cutting Board	Perceived Tenderness
0 Minutes (Cut Immediately)	Pinched tight; high internal hydrostatic pressure	8 to 10 teaspoons lost (Dry meat)	Chewy exterior, wet plate puddle
3 Minutes (Half Rested)	Partially relaxed; core still stabilizing	4 to 5 teaspoons lost	Moderately juicy
6 to 8 Minutes (Full Rest @ ~125°F)	Fibers widened; dissolved proteins thicken juices	Under 1.5 teaspoons lost (Retains 85%+)	Velvety, evenly moist edge-to-edge
25+ Minutes on Cold Plate (Over-Rested)	Fat congeals below 100°F	Minimal juice loss, but lukewarm	Serve on preheated ceramic plates!

■ WHEN TO TENT WITH FOIL VS. WHEN TO NEVER USE FOIL

Cooking & Crust Style	Foil Verdict	Scientific Reason & Best Resting Surface
Cast-Iron Seared Steaks & Chops	NO FOIL (Uncovered)	Trapped steam softens hard-earned Maillard crust; rest on warm wire rack
Crispy-Skin Roast Chicken, Turkey & Pork Belly	NO FOIL (Uncovered)	Steam turns blistered crackling skin rubbery in 3 minutes
Breaded / Fried Cutlets & Air Fryer Wings	NO FOIL (Wire Rack)	Set on cooling rack over sheet pan so bottom breading stays crunchy
Lean Boneless Chicken Breast & Pork Loin	LOOSE FOIL TENT	No crispy skin to lose; loose foil prevents evaporative cooling
Smoked BBQ Brisket & Pork Shoulder (203°F)	TIGHT WRAP + COOLER	Holding between 200°F down to 145°F for 2 hrs continues melting collagen

CHEF'S PRO TIP: Prevent the 'Soggy Bottom' on expensive steaks: When resting a crusty cast-iron steak on a flat plate, condensation pools underneath and steams the bottom crust soft. Rest steaks on an elevated wire cooling rack or across two wooden chopsticks!
USDA SAFE MINIMUM INTERNAL TEMPS: All Poultry: 165°F (74°C) • Ground Beef/Pork/Lamb: 160°F (71°C) • Whole Steaks, Roasts, Pork & Fish: 145°F (63°C)